

Production Buddy

Capabilities Breakdown — what each function actually does

v1.0.14

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Overview

This document lists every capability Production Buddy ships with, grouped by function. Each entry gives a one-line description, a note on when to use it, and the specific things it can do.

A. Markup → Edits engine

What: Reads PDF reviewer comments and applies them to the source InDesign/Illustrator file.

When to use: After a stakeholder review pass on a PDF.

Edit operations supported

- **Replace text** — strikethrough + sticky-note replacement, or a sticky note alone with new text
 - **Insert text** — caret annotations with a sticky note (including single-symbol inserts like ®, ™, ©)
 - **Delete text** — strikethrough alone (deletes just the marked text)
 - **Add table row** — annotated row appended to a target table
 - **Insert row at index** — new row at a specific position
 - **Delete row** — strikethrough on a row
 - **Sort table** — instruction-style annotation (“sort alphabetically”)
 - **Set cell value** — change one cell without disturbing the rest
 - **Set cell fill / text color** — comments like “change this row to gray”, or a CMYK / hex color spec
 - **Set cell stroke** — “delete this border line” / “make this rule lighter”
 - **Set text style (bold / italic toggle)** — comments like “remove bold from this en dash” / “make this italic”: the app locates the marked text and toggles the bold/italic state via the matching `FontStyle` name (Bold/Black/Heavy/Regular/Italic, etc.)
 - **Move text to next line** — comments like “move ENERGY down to next line” / “wrap X to next line” / “break before X”: the app inserts a forced line break before the target word, anchored on 4 words of context so it only affects the highlighted instance
 - **Match text size to other fields** — “make this same size as other fields”: finds peer form-label paragraphs on the same page, applies their modal paragraph style
 - **Relink image** — “swap this logo for <name>”
 - **Delete page**
 - **Append pages from another .indd**
 - **Place asset into a frame** / on a new page
 - **Human review escalation** — anything ambiguous lands in a human-review queue rather than guessing
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B. Hi-res image swap

What: Replaces watermarked stock-photo comps with their licensed hi-res equivalents.

When to use: Before final output if comps were placed during design.

- Extracts each placed image's stock-photo numeric ID (Getty, Adobe Stock, Shutterstock)
 - Searches the supplied hi-res images folder for a matching file
 - Matches with or without an ICF_ filename prefix
 - Re-links the .indd entry; the original asset path is preserved as a comment in the run log
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C. Reference-file routing

What: Lets the markup reference external assets by name.

When to use: When the reviewer wrote "append the rebate sheet" or "place the new map here".

Supported types: .indd, .pdf, .ai, .psd, raster images.

D. Production QA checks

What: Reads the document after edits and flags production issues.

Auto-fixed silently (no action needed)

- Whitespace cleanup (multiple spaces, trailing spaces)
- Smart quotes (straight → typographic “ ” ‘ ’)
- Doubled punctuation (... → ..., doubled commas collapsed)
- ® / ™ / © superscripted
- **Bold-boundary preservation in REPLACE_TEXT** — when a replace spans a bold→regular transition at – (en-dash with surrounding spaces), the new text's bold range is re-applied so a label like *Invoice for installed measures* stays bold up to the dash even after the replacement adds new words to the bold prefix
- **Mismatched mailto: hyperlinks** — when the visible text is an email but the underlying mailto: destination points elsewhere, the link is repointed to mailto:<visible-email>

Errors (must fix before publish)

- Images below 300 dpi effective
- Missing linked assets
- Fonts not properly installed
- Overset text

Warnings (review and decide)

- Hyperlink text doesn't match destination (URL-style mismatches; mailto auto-fix removes most of these)
- Broken hyperlinks (4xx/5xx)
- URL-like text without an active hyperlink
- Paragraph style overrides
- Many distinct fonts (>4 by default)
- RGB swatches in a print doc
- Rich black on small text (≤14pt body)
- Hyphen used where en-dash likely intended
- Empty paragraphs
- No bleed configured
- Linked assets out of date
- Possible spelling issues

Info inventory (FYI)

- Hyperlink count, image count, font list, spot colors, color profile, page dimensions, bleed settings, hidden layers with content, locked items, master-page overrides, overprint preferences
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E. Section 508 compliance check

What: Triggered by the checkbox on tab 1.

- Text/background color contrast $\geq 4.5:1$
 - All line weights $\geq 1\text{pt}$
 - Alt text on every placed image
 - Document metadata: title, author, subject, keywords
 - Forces “Create Tagged PDF” on export
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F. Brand-guide library

What: A persistent library of parsed brand guides. Tab 1 has a Brand Guide picker; saved guides live in the app’s userData folder and auto-match by filename on subsequent runs.

- Parses a brand-guide PDF for swatches and fonts
 - Saves under ~/Library/Application Support/Production Buddy/brand-guides/<name>.json
 - Auto-loads any saved guide whose name appears as a substring of the .indd filename (case-insensitive)
 - Picker modal when 2+ guides match
 - Manual brand-guide selection wins; library edits take effect on the very next file pick
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G. Auto-relink missing assets

What: When asset links are broken, scans Box folders for the named files and reconnects them.

H. Auto-activate missing fonts

What: When fonts are missing, instructs FontExplorer X Pro to activate them.

I. Batch Data Merge

What: Generates per-record .indd files from a tagged template + data.

- Auto-flattens Excel workbooks into a CSV
- Or accepts a pre-flattened CSV
- Applies InDesign Data Merge against the template
- Per-record image folder support: matches files by record name, exposes them as an @image column
- Writes one .indd per record

J. Tag a Template

What: Reverse of Data Merge — turns a one-record InDesign file into a tagged template.

- Reads the reference state's values from Excel files
- Scans the .indd for those literal values
- Replaces them with <<placeholder>> tokens
- Writes a tagged copy

K. Local AI classifier (Ollama, optional)

What: Local LLM that handles ambiguous markup the rule-based matcher can't.

- Runs entirely on the local machine — no API keys
- Default model: llama3.1:8b (~5GB one-time download)
- Anything still ambiguous lands in HUMAN_REVIEW
- Optional